

Assort Health

As an undergraduate student studying bioinformatics¹ at Stanford University, Jon Wang took as many computer science courses as he could fit in his schedule. He had grown fascinated by the potential of artificial intelligence (AI). Wang went on to attend medical school at the University of California San Francisco, and after his second year there—in the midst of a global pandemic—he had a life-altering realization: He could probably help more people with AI than with a scalpel. Wang was eager to combine his interest in AI with his passion for healthcare, but he wasn't sure exactly how. What specific problem could AI solve for patients and healthcare providers to help make exceptional healthcare available, anytime, anywhere, for everyone?

Building a Team

If Wang was going to realize this ambitious goal to transform healthcare availability using AI, he knew he was going to need a business partner. He could not manage the workload of developing and building a product, recruiting software engineers, and cultivating clients on his own. Wang spoke with 53 potential cofounders, 20 of whom warranted second conversations, and offered the top five a tryout to work with him in his fledgling office. It was immediately evident that when he worked with Jeffery Liu, it was a partnership built for success. Liu initially studied pre-med biomedical engineering at Duke University, worked as a software engineer at Meta, and built one of the first generative voice AI scribes², all of which brought unique and essential technical skills to the joint venture.

Together, Wang and Liu translated their vision into a product they hoped would outlast them both: Assort Health, a service that incorporates large language models³ and machine learning to provide AI voice assistants for medical clinics.

Defining the Problem

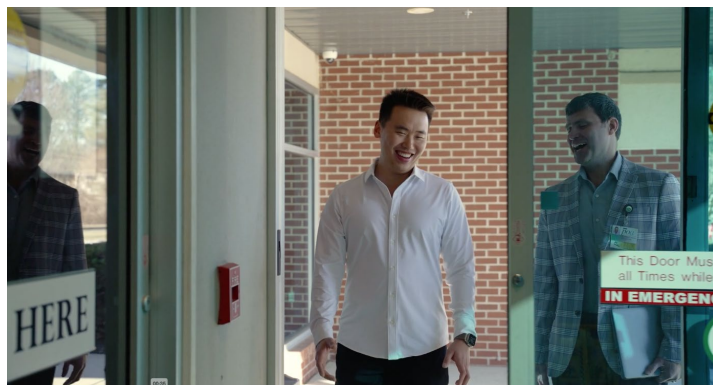
Once Liu was on board, the two began talking to prospective customers (Figure 1)—including hospital directors, doctors, office staff, and patients—to identify what their greatest challenges and business inefficiencies were. They kept coming back to the same issue - the mismatch between office staff and the volume of telephone calls. Because there are only so many personnel available to answer patient calls, and patients can call at any time of day, there wasn't a predictable way to increase staff availability at specific high-call volume periods. Some offices reported wait times as long as 90 minutes and issues with patients abandoning calls. According

¹ Bioinformatics is an interdisciplinary field that uses technology to analyze biological data, such as genetic data.

² A voice AI scribe converts an audio conversation into written notes.

³ A large language model is a type of machine learning, like Chat GPT, that is trained to use natural language, including syntax and semantics.

to a 2021 report, one-fourth of all U.S. spending on healthcare was on administration, with tens of billions of dollars spent on patient services like call centers alone (Sahni et al. 2021).



“There was a huge pain point around patients waiting on hold and doctors having bad experiences with call centers,⁴” Wang said. The partners wanted to offer simpler, speedier interactions for patients while reducing costs for businesses. They recognized that this was the perfect challenge for their desired AI-centered product.

Figure 1. Jeffery Liu meeting with a potential client

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Product Development

Assort Health’s AI product would be able to effectively handle appointment management, triage calls,⁵ take patient information, and refill prescriptions. In addition, it could communicate in a variety of languages and easily manage an influx of callers at any time of day.

To build the product, Wang and Liu needed to develop an AI agent that would do the work of a human in real time. That required a design partner, someone who had handled hundreds of thousands of patient calls that could be leveraged to train the AI. A friend’s uncle who runs a large orthopedic group was able to help. With appropriate consent, Wang and Liu used recordings of calls, including the questions patients asked and the responses the receptionists provided, to build Assort Health’s AI to effectively handle both simple and complex tasks.

After thoroughly training their AI, including on practice-specific guidelines, the product was ready to be piloted by the orthopedic group that helped them develop their AI.

After a successful pilot, Assort Health launched its product in 2023, and it took off. According to audits performed by Assort Health team members, they achieved a 98.6% accuracy at addressing callers’ needs, exceeding the industry average. By early 2025, Assort Health had 23 employees, thousands of healthcare providers signed up, and more than 10 million patient interactions. Assort Health’s AI helped patients book their appointments, create new patient files, send cancellations, and communicate in the patient’s preferred language. According to Wang, Assort

⁴ A call center is a service set up to manage phone calls for other businesses. Hospitals and medical clinics may outsource patient calls to call centers to allow office staff to prioritize patient care.

⁵ Triage means evaluating and prioritizing calls so that the most urgent matters are attended to first.

Topic 4.1 Case

Health's platform reduced patient wait times to seconds and cost healthcare systems and clinics 50% less than their previous approaches (relying on office receptionists or call centers).

As a result of their early success, the company had raised \$26 million in funding by 2025 and was ready to hire 40 more people. Wang and Liu had only just begun to realize the full scope of their ambition – their resolve to reshape the future of healthcare through AI.

Jon Wang was interviewed in 2025 by a College Board case author for this case study.

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